Carnegie Mellon University

Aayan Sharma <aayans@andrew.cmu.edu>

Research GPU Cluster Access Request

4 messages

Aayan Sharma <aayans@andrew.cmu.edu> Mon, Jun 29, 2026 at 4:06 PM
To: ECE IT Services <help@ece.cmu.edu>
Cc: Tze Meng Low <lowt@andrew.cmu.edu>

Hi ECE IT Services,

I hope you are doing well. I am an undergraduate researcher in the ECE department working under Professor Tze Meng Low. I am writing to request access to the research GPU cluster for ongoing work in our group.

Please let me know if you need any additional information to process this request.

Thank you,
Aayan Sharma

ITS Support via RT <help@ece.cmu.edu> Mon, Jun 29, 2026 at 4:06 PM
Reply-To: help@ece.cmu.edu
To: aayans@andrew.cmu.edu

Hello,

Your request concerning "Research GPU Cluster Access Request" has been automatically assigned an ID of 664304. There is no need to reply to this message right now.

For future correspondence about this issue, please reply to this message. If your ticket requires an immediate response, or there are deadlines associated with this ticket, please let us know. We can also be reached at 412 268-1732.

For general information about ITS and ECE computing resources, please visit the user guide: https://userguide.ece.cmu.edu.

This ticketing system is used by a number of different groups. In the future, if you have an issue specific to one of the areas below, you may receive quicker service by sending a message to the appropriate address. You do not need to resend this request, as we will make sure it is directed to the correct area.

For help with:	Send email to:
ECE Receiving	receiving@ece.cmu.edu
ECE Building Facilities	facilities@ece.cmu.edu
ECE Labs	labs@ece.cmu.edu
ECE Web issues	web@ece.cmu.edu
General IT issues	help@ece.cmu.edu

Chad Ziccardi via RT <help@ece.cmu.edu> Wed, Jul 1, 2026 at 12:25 PM
Reply-To: help@ece.cmu.edu
To: aayans@andrew.cmu.edu

On Mon Jun 29 16:06:51 2026, aayans@andrew.cmu.edu wrote:
> Hi ECE IT Services,
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> department working under Professor Tze Meng Low. I am writing to request

> access to the research GPU cluster for ongoing work in our group.
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> Please let me know if you need any additional information to process this
> request.

The ECE GPU Phd cluster is for Phd only.

PSC definitely has resources for non-phd students

Flame/orchard might.

I'll include both below:

For other students, Pittsburgh SuperComputing via ACCESS can have an allocation created to get the ability to use many more powerful GPUs.

I'll attach info below for PSC, and grant access to the DSC hosts.

CMU FLAME / Orchard were recent announcements that target CMU faculty (and their students), but I've not yet aware if everyone can be granted access or not.

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CMU FLAME / Orchard is another set via linux/slurm (via google compute 296x H100) Unfortunately I do not have direct knowledge of how access works for these. https://www.cmu.edu/computing/services/research/cloud-cluster/ and https://www.cmu.edu/flame/

Flame - https://www.cmu.edu/flame/
ORCHARD - https://www.cmu.edu/rcd/request.html

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PSC/ACCESS -
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PSC/Bridges-2

ACCESS allocation on Bridges-2 at Pittsburgh SuperComputer (PSC)

For the Campus Champion allocation, we require individual users (ideally Andrew IDs, these should be created / authenticated by CMU shibboleth), no shared accounts. Campus Champion allocation is shared across the entire university, and is not good for large scale GPU research. For GPU resources it can be good for short/proof of concept, however getting a project ACCESS allocation is strongly recommended. (We get 1-2K GPU hours a year for the Campus Champion allocation, a researcher can easily use that within a week or two).

Federated account creation: https://identity.access-ci.org/new-user-federated

If you have external users (not currently with an Andrew account) these can likely be added via sponsored, or non-federated as needed. (sponsored https://www.cmu.edu/computing/services/security/identity-access/account/sponsored.html)

For own allocations, the PI must be a single person with a CV (this can be grad student themselves) https://allocations.access-ci.org/access-allocations-policies, there are easy ways to add multiple users for management of the allocations.

A bit about ACCESS:

However ACCESS (PSC/Bridges or any national lab, though we usually use PSC) does not charge for access to resources, and we strongly encourage folks to apply for ACCESS Allocations for access to large amounts of CPU/GPU/Memory resources for both course and research project allocations.

This is part of my standard responses when asked about these:

ACCESS/PSC allocations are also an excellent way to get access to a large amount of resources, which should also be used if able (GPUS: ~280 NVIDIA V100s, ~80 H100s), ~500 compute nodes)
https://www.psc.edu/resources/bridges-2/user-guide/#system-configuration
[we default to request these as the resource available per allocation]

These can be done here:
https://allocations.access-ci.org/get-your-first-project
https://allocations.access-ci.org/project-types

Professors and grad students can apply, we'll also assist with the creation of the allocations if desired. It's fairly painless for the lower tiers (3 page PDF CV, 1 paragraph/page of what you want to use the resources for), the larger allocations require a bit more, but easy to start off with the EXPLORE/DISCOVER tier and grow.

You apply for the ACCESS "credits" then exchange them on the PSC for service units (GPU,CPU,storage etc).
Things are charged back to the credits, no actual money exchanges for allocations.
Depending on how the allocation is set up, they sometimes email you the "what this would cost in dollars" so research that uses it can cite it, and thus help them get larger grants in the future.

"What is ACCESS?
ACCESS is a program established and funded by the National Science Foundation (NSF) to help researchers and educators utilize the nation’s advanced computing systems and services. Almost any computer application that requires more than a desktop or laptop could qualify as needing an advanced computing system. Examples include supercomputer applications, AI and machine learning, big data analysis and storage, and others.

ACCESS is an acronym that stands for “Advanced Cyberinfrastructure Coordination Ecosystem: Services & Support.” NSF awarded $52 million over five years to five lead institutions and their sub-awardees to facilitate the ACCESS program. You can find out more about how ACCESS is organized here."

https://access-ci.org/about/ has more information specifically:
"How much does it cost?
Nothing. ACCESS resources and services are free, with the exception of some resources that are offered to companies on a fee basis. Also, the MATCH Premier service can help you find expert consultants for more extensive engagements that would be funded by your project."

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Chad Ziccardi ziccardi@ece.cmu.edu
Principal Systems Engineer Hamerschlag Hall A210
ECE Computing Facilities Pittsburgh, PA, 15213

tM Low via RT <help@ece.cmu.edu> Wed, Jul 1, 2026 at 1:07 PM
Reply-To: help@ece.cmu.edu
To: aayans@andrew.cmu.edu

Hi Chad,

Thanks for the clarification. We will look at the other resources.

Best regards,
Tze Meng

On Wed, Jul 1, 2026 at 12:25 PM Chad Ziccardi via RT <help@ece.cmu.edu> wrote:

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